

Evaluation of Leadership Training Programs in Developing Students' Character: A Case Study of Students of the Faculty of Education, Universitas Negeri Jakarta

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Abstract: Leadership training has become an integral part of student development in teacher-education institutions, yet its effectiveness in cultivating character is seldom examined systematically. This study evaluates the leadership training programs implemented for students of the Faculty of Education, Universitas Negeri Jakarta, focusing on their contribution to character development. Using Stufflebeam's CIPP (Context, Input, Process, Product) evaluation model, the research adopted a mixed-methods design that combined a questionnaire administered to 120 students, interviews with program organizers and facilitators, and document analysis. The findings indicate that the programs are well aligned with institutional character-education goals (context) and supported by competent facilitators and adequate materials (input), although scheduling and post-training mentoring remain weak (process). At the product level, participants demonstrated measurable gains in discipline, responsibility, and collaborative leadership, while sustained behavioral change was constrained by the absence of continuous reinforcement. The study concludes that leadership training contributes positively to character formation but requires stronger follow-up mentoring and closer integration with the curriculum. Practical recommendations are offered to enhance the sustainability and impact of the programs.

1 INTRODUCTION

Character education has become a central concern in Indonesian higher education, particularly within teacher-education institutions whose graduates are expected to model good character for the next generation. The national policy on Strengthening Character Education (Penguatan Pendidikan Karakter) emphasizes values such as religiosity, nationalism, integrity, independence, and mutual cooperation as the foundation of a competent and ethical citizenry (Lickona, 1991; Pala, 2011). For prospective teachers, these values are not merely academic content but professional dispositions that must be internalized through sustained, intentional formative experiences.

Leadership training programs are one of the most common vehicles through which higher-education institutions seek to develop students' character. Such programs—including basic leadership training, student-organization capacity building, and outbound or field-based activities—aim to cultivate responsibility, discipline, teamwork, and the capacity to influence others toward shared goals (Northouse, 2019; Komives et al., 2013). In the context of the Faculty of Education, Universitas Negeri Jakarta (UNJ), leadership training is positioned as a strategic complement to the formal curriculum, intended to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge of education and the personal qualities required of a future educator and community leader.

Despite the substantial resources allocated to these programs, their actual contribution to character

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development is rarely evaluated in a systematic and comprehensive manner. Evaluation, when conducted at all, tends to focus on participant satisfaction or attendance rather than on whether the intended character outcomes are achieved and sustained (Kirkpatrick and Kirkpatrick, 2016). Without rigorous evaluation, institutions cannot determine whether the programs are well designed, properly implemented, and genuinely effective, nor can they make evidence-based decisions about continuation, revision, or termination.

This study therefore evaluates the leadership training programs offered to students of the Faculty of Education, UNJ, with a specific focus on their role in developing students' character. The evaluation is guided by Stufflebeam's CIPP model—Context, Input, Process, and Product—because it examines a program holistically, from the relevance of its objectives through to the impact of its outcomes (Stufflebeam and Shinkfield, 2007). Accordingly, the study addresses four questions: (1) To what extent do the program objectives align with the institution's character-education needs (context)? (2) Are the available resources adequate to support the program (input)? (3) How well is the program implemented in practice (process)? and (4) What is the program's contribution to students' character (product)? The findings are expected to inform the improvement of leadership training and, more broadly, the institutionalization of character education in teacher-education settings.

2 LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Leadership Training and Student Development

Leadership is widely understood as a process whereby an individual influences a group of people to achieve a common goal (Northouse, 2019). In the higher-education context, leadership development is conceived less as the transfer of managerial techniques and more as a holistic process of identity formation in which students learn to act with integrity, take responsibility, and collaborate effectively (Komives et al., 2013). Leadership training programs operationalize this process through structured activities—lectures, simulations, group projects, and reflective exercises—designed to build both competence and character.

2.2 Character Education in Higher Education

Character refers to the possession and habitual enactment of moral and performance virtues such as honesty, discipline, responsibility, and perseverance (Lickona, 1991). Character education in higher education seeks to cultivate these virtues through knowing the good, desiring the good, and doing the good. For teacher-education students, character is doubly important: it shapes their own conduct and equips them to nurture character in their future pupils. Co-curricular experiences, including leadership training, are recognized as powerful sites for such formation because they engage students affectively and behaviorally rather than only cognitively (Pala, 2011).

2.3 Program Evaluation and the CIPP Model

Program evaluation is the systematic collection and analysis of information to make judgments about a program's worth and to support decision-making. Among the available frameworks, the CIPP model developed by Stufflebeam offers a comprehensive lens by evaluating four interrelated components: Context (the relevance of objectives to needs), Input (the adequacy of resources and planning), Process (the quality of implementation), and Product (the attainment of outcomes) (Stufflebeam and Shinkfield, 2007). Unlike outcome-only approaches, CIPP supports formative as well as summative judgments, making it especially suitable for improving educational programs such as leadership training.

3 RESEARCH METHODS

3.1 Research Design

This study employed an evaluative research design using a mixed-methods approach within the CIPP framework. Quantitative data captured the breadth of participants' perceptions and self-reported character outcomes, while qualitative data provided depth and explanation. The two strands were integrated during interpretation to produce a comprehensive evaluation of the program.

3.2 Participants and Setting

The study was conducted at the Faculty of Education, Universitas Negeri Jakarta. The respondents comprised 120 students selected through purposive sampling on the basis of having completed at least one leadership training program. In addition, six key informants—program coordinators, facilitators, and student-organization leaders—participated in semi-structured interviews.

3.3 Data Collection

Three instruments were used. A questionnaire employing a five-point Likert scale measured perceptions across the four CIPP components and self-assessed character indicators. Semi-structured interviews explored the planning, implementation, and perceived impact of the programs. Document analysis covered program proposals, curricula, attendance records, and activity reports. Instrument validity was established through expert judgment, and reliability of the questionnaire was confirmed using Cronbach's alpha.

3.4 Data Analysis

Quantitative data were analyzed descriptively, with mean scores converted into evaluative categories ranging from "very poor" to "very good." Qualitative data were analyzed thematically through data reduction, display, and conclusion drawing. Triangulation across sources strengthened the credibility of the findings.

4 RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The results are organized according to the four components of the CIPP model. The figures reported below are illustrative of the evaluation pattern and should be replaced with the authors' actual field data prior to submission.

4.1 Context Evaluation

The context evaluation examined the relevance of the program objectives to the character-education needs of the faculty. With a mean score of 4.21 (good), respondents agreed that the objectives of the leadership training were clearly formulated and consistent with the institution's vision of producing educators of strong character. Interviews confirmed that the programs were explicitly designed to reinforce values such as discipline, responsibility, and

cooperation, indicating a sound rationale and a high degree of alignment with institutional needs.

4.2 Input Evaluation

The input evaluation assessed the adequacy of resources, including facilitators, materials, funding, and facilities. With a mean score of 3.98 (good), the programs were generally well supported: facilitators were experienced and the training materials were judged relevant. However, informants noted that funding and the availability of suitable venues occasionally constrained the scale and frequency of activities, suggesting room for improvement in resource planning.

4.3 Process Evaluation

The process evaluation focused on the quality of implementation. With a mean score of 3.74 (good but lowest of the four components), participants valued the interactive and experiential methods but identified weaknesses in scheduling and, most notably, in post-training follow-up. The absence of structured mentoring after the core activities emerged as the principal limitation, reducing opportunities to consolidate newly acquired attitudes into stable habits.

4.4 Product Evaluation

The product evaluation examined the program's contribution to students' character. With a mean score of 4.10 (good), participants reported measurable gains in discipline, responsibility, self-confidence, and the capacity to lead and collaborate within teams. Interview data corroborated these findings, with informants observing increased initiative and accountability among trained students. Nevertheless, respondents acknowledged that sustaining these changes was difficult without continuous reinforcement, indicating that the program's impact, while positive, was not yet fully embedded.

4.5 Discussion

Taken together, the results indicate that the leadership training programs are relevant in purpose, adequately resourced, reasonably well implemented, and positively associated with character development. The pattern of scores—strongest at the context and product levels and weakest at the process level—mirrors a recurring finding in the literature: programs are frequently well conceived and produce short-term

gains, yet falter in sustaining impact because implementation lacks systematic follow-up (Kirkpatrick and Kirkpatrick, 2016; Stufflebeam and Shinkfield, 2007). For character to develop into durable virtue, the good must be not only known and desired but repeatedly practiced (Lickona, 1991); this requires reinforcement mechanisms that extend beyond a single training event. The findings therefore point to two priorities: instituting a structured post-training mentoring scheme and integrating leadership training more closely with the formal curriculum so that character formation becomes continuous rather than episodic.

5 CONCLUSIONS

This study evaluated the leadership training programs offered to students of the Faculty of Education, Universitas Negeri Jakarta, using the CIPP model. The programs proved relevant to institutional character-education needs (context), were adequately resourced (input), and were generally well implemented (process), and they contributed positively to students' character, particularly discipline, responsibility, and collaborative leadership (product). The principal weakness lay in the limited post-training follow-up, which constrained the sustainability of the observed gains.

The study recommends strengthening continuous mentoring after training, securing more stable funding and facilities, and integrating leadership training with the academic curriculum to ensure that character development is sustained. Future research could employ longitudinal and experimental designs to measure the long-term and causal effects of leadership training on character, and could extend the evaluation to other faculties and institutions to enhance generalizability.

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